

Rent & Eviction Help

Behind on rent or facing eviction? Acting fast matters — free legal help and local rental assistance can keep you housed. Below are the most trusted national starting points. Tick the box once you've contacted each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

The big federal pandemic rental program (ERA2) ended in 2025, so rental help now comes through local programs, charities, and legal aid. Never pay a fee to apply for rental assistance — real programs are free. If you have a court date, get legal help right away.

1 Find Local Rental Assistance

Federal money now flows through state and local programs. These official tools point you to what's open near you.

☐ CFPB — Find Rental Assistance Near You

The official government tool that lists rental and utility assistance programs by state, county, and city.
→ www.consumerfinance.gov/coronavirus/mortgage-and-housing-assistance/renter-protections/find-help-with-rent-and-utilities

☐ 211 — Local Rent Help

Call or search to find emergency rent funds, charities, and housing help in your area.
→ www.211.org or dial 211

2 Free Legal Help to Fight Eviction

If you've gotten an eviction notice or court date, a free tenant lawyer can often stop or delay it, or get back rent waived.

☐ HUD Eviction Protection — Free Tenant Legal Aid

Free legal services for low-income tenants at risk of eviction, funded by HUD. Find a provider through legal aid below.
→ www.lawhelp.org

☐ Legal Services Corporation — Find Legal Aid

Find your local free legal aid office for help with eviction, lease problems, and tenant rights.
→ www.lsc.gov/about-lsc/what-legal-aid/get-legal-help

3 Talk to a HUD Housing Counselor

Free, expert counselors help you understand your options, contact your landlord, and find assistance — at no cost.

☐ HUD-Approved Housing Counseling

Free counseling on renting, eviction, and avoiding homelessness. Find a HUD-approved counselor near you.
→ www.hud.gov/findacounselor

☐ HUD Housing Counselor Line

Call to be connected with a free local housing counselor.
→ 1-800-569-4287

4 Know Your Rights

Understanding the rules in your state can buy you time and protect you from illegal eviction.

☐ USA.gov — Tenant Rights

Plain-language overview of renter rights and where to report problems in your state.

→ www.usa.gov/housing-rental-issues

☐ Find Your Local Public Housing Agency

For Section 8, public housing waitlists, and emergency housing options.

→ www.hud.gov/helping-americans/public-housing-agency-contact-information

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Old sites still say you can apply for the federal “ERA” or “Emergency Rental Assistance” program — that federal round ended in 2025. Use the CFPB tool and 211 to find what’s actually open. Never pay an upfront fee.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

If you have an eviction court date, get free legal help immediately — even one day matters. Many tenants who show up with a lawyer avoid eviction or get extra time to move.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Ask for your personalized rent-help search

This guide covers the main national starting points. For rent funds, legal aid, and emergency housing specific to your city or ZIP code, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we’ll help you find what’s open near you.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
